



ENVIRONMENTAL INSTITUTE

Climate Collaborative RFP Addendum

June 2025

Change of scope

In response to changes in the federal funding landscape, UVA and its departments and institutes are re-evaluating their spending plans and budgets. As part of the UVA community, we at the Environmental Institute want to be thoughtful partners in that effort. At the same time, we remain deeply committed to supporting high-impact, collaborative research that advances the mission of the Climate Collaborative Initiative.

To balance these goals, we are adjusting the scale of this year's Climate Collaborative awards. Our goal is to continue supporting this important work while also ensuring that resources continue to reach parts of the research community that are especially vulnerable to funding shifts, such as early-career faculty, graduate students, and postdocs. We hope that by reducing the scope of individual awards, we'll be able to support more teams overall and help keep our research community active and connected during this tighter funding period.

This addendum outlines changes to the anticipated funding amount, proposal requirements, and review criteria. Any elements not explicitly addressed here remain unchanged and should follow the original RFP guidance.

Anticipated Funding Amount

We will award project teams up to \$500,000 total over a project duration of 2 to 3 years, as determined by the team. The committee will evaluate proposals individually and in the context of the full applicant pool in order to fund as many teams as possible within the revised budget. Thus, the review committee will favor proposals that request less than the \$500,000 cap, where appropriate, and encourage applicants to propose the smallest budget necessary to accomplish meaningful and impactful work.

At the end of the first project year, based on the funding landscape, institutional priorities, and a review of year one progress, we may invite funded teams to apply for additional funding to augment the work described in your original proposal. While we cannot guarantee this opportunity, we want teams to know that we are thinking ahead and are committed to supporting the Climate Collaboratives to the fullest extent possible.

Proposal Submission Deadline

September 15th, 2025

Please email all proposal materials to Amelie Berger (Project Manager) at acb4rk@virginia.edu.

Changes to Full Proposal Requirements

Project Description:

Remains the same in content, **now with a 10-page limit**.

Budget, Budget Justification, and Personnel:

Budgets should still be thoughtfully constructed, aligning with the actual needs of the project and reflecting a balance between research activities and partner support. Under the revised scope, we encourage applicants to think carefully about what's essential to carry out meaningful work. Proposals that prioritize support for UVA personnel, particularly groups most vulnerable in the current funding environment — such as early-career faculty, graduate students, and postdocs — will be viewed more favorably.

A community liaison remains an essential role to ensure meaningful, authentic community engagement. However, the previously recommended part-time project manager is likely no longer necessary given the reduced project scale and would have to be well justified if included in the budget.

To help teams succeed under this new structure, EI will provide increased centralized support, including communications and community engagement training and some project management resources.

Updated Selection Criteria

Core review criteria remain as outlined in the original RFP. In addition, the review committee will:

- Look more closely at how well budgets align with the specified needs of the proposed projects. Proposals in which the modified scope is well-supported by budget requests will be viewed more favorably.
- Prioritize budgets that support roles that are most vulnerable in this funding climate, such as graduate students, postdocs, and early-career faculty.

We recognize that these changes will require teams to adjust their plans, and we appreciate your flexibility as we adapt to a shifting funding landscape. Our hope is that this revised approach will allow us to keep supporting strong, collaborative work.

If you have any questions, feel free to reach out to Amelie Berger at acb4rk@virginia.edu.